

Entry to the Middle Way
by Chandrakirti (ca. 600-670)

1. COMPLETE JOY

Shravakas and pratyekabuddhas are born from the Muni king;
Buddhas are born from bodhisattvas;
And, from the mind of compassion, non-duality and
Bodhicitta is born the bodhisattva.

Compassion alone is first seed for the abundant harvest of buddhahood;
Then water for its growth,
And finally, what matures as a state of lasting enjoyment –
Therefore, first I praise compassion.

Initially fixating on this so-called ‘I’ as an [existing] self,
‘Mine’ gives rise to grasping.
Helpless beings, driven as an irrigation wheel,
To compassion for these, I bow down.

Sentient beings are as the moon’s reflection in moving water.
Seeing them as empty in their change and in their nature,
The victorious one’s son, possessing such understanding,
And overcome by compassion, wishes to completely liberate all beings.

Fully dedicated as in the Aspirations of Samantabhadra,
His joy is complete. This is known as the first.
With this attainment, from now on
He is known as a bodhisattva

Now born into the family of the Tathagatas
Completely abandoning the three constant fetters,
The bodhisattva possesses supreme delight
And is able to stir a hundred worlds.

Joyfully progressing from bhumi to bhumi
The various paths to the lower realms have ended;
The levels of ordinary existence are exhausted.
This is taught to be like the eighth sublime level.

Striving for enlightenment, even when remaining on the first level,
He defeats those born from the speech of the Sage King, including pratyekabuddhas.
And, through ever-increasing merit,
On “Far Gone”, his understanding also becomes greater.

Here, the first cause for perfect enlightenment,
Generosity, is the most important.
Giving his flesh with enthusiasm,
Infers what is not seen.

Ordinary individuals, craving happiness,
Cannot live without comfort.
Recognising that comfort comes from generosity,
It was this the Muni spoke of first.

Uncompassionate, extremely insensitive,
Striving solely for personal benefit –
Even such individuals will obtain comforts,
And have all sufferings pacified, through generosity.

Furthermore, practising generosity,
They will swiftly meet with a superior,
Completely cutting the stream of samsara.
Having such a cause, they proceed to the yield of peace.

Those pledged to others’ welfare,
Will soon gain happiness through generosity.
Hence, for those with compassion and those without
The importance of generosity is stressed.

When hearing or thinking of “give!”
The pleasure of a bodhisattva
Exceeds the pleasure of the arhat’s nirvana,
Not to mention [the joy of] giving everything.

Suffering when cutting and giving his body,
He realises the pain
Others endure in the hells and so forth.
He thus endeavours in eradicating suffering.

Giving, which is empty of giver, gift and receiver –

Is known as transcendent paramita.
Attachment to these three
Is taught as being ordinary paramita.

The bodhisattva, firmly established in such mind,
Has become a holy being, ravishing and radiant with joy,
Which, as the water crystal jewel,
Perfectly vanquishes dense darkness.

2. STAINLESS

Here, because he possesses perfect discipline
He abandons the stains of faulty ethics, even in dreams.
Because deeds of body, speech and mind are pure,
He accumulates the ten-fold aspect of the sacred path

On this tenfold path of virtue,
As he progresses, it becomes exceedingly pure.
As the autumn moon, ever immaculate [discipline]
Is ravishing in its soothing light.

Dwelling on the purity of his own discipline,
Is not pure discipline.
Thus in regard to its three [aspects], at all times
He is perfectly free of the engagements of dualistic mind.

Having comforts through generosity, yet miserable,
This arises from breaking the limb of discipline.
Having exhausted all your investments,
Later these will not yield much comfort.

Dwelling independently in an agreeable place,
One may still not be able to stay,
Falling into an abyss and losing one's independence,
How will one get out later on?

For this reason, having spoken of generosity,
The Buddha spoke of discipline.
Qualities grown in the pasture of discipline,

Yield unending fruits of enjoyment.

Ordinary individuals, speech-born,
Those certainly possessing enlightenment for themselves,
And bodhisattvas, all attain certain excellence and
Higher rebirth solely from discipline.

Just as a corpse and the ocean,
And auspiciousness and misfortune [cannot] co-exist,
So a great sovereign applying himself to discipline,
Cannot live with carelessness.

Who abandons, what is abandoned, and for whom –
Discipline with these three points of reference,
Is taught to be ordinary paramita;
Absence of clinging to these three, transcendent.

The moon-like bodhisattva while non-worldly,
Is the glory of this world.
Like the radiance of the autumn moon – the Stainless –
His stainlessness soothes the anguish of sentient beings.

3. LUMINOUS

Because the wisdom-fire, burning the firewood of all phenomena,
Blazes, so the third bhumi
[Is called] 'Luminous'. Here as the son of the Sugata
Radiates like the sun's copper light.

Although he is innocent, aggressive individuals may
Carve from his flesh and bones,
Slowly, measure by measure,
Yet, such dissection merely makes his patience grow.

Because for the bodhisattva who sees selflessness
Victim, perpetrator, moment, manner,
Purpose – are all seen as a reflection,
[He attains] patience.

If you take revenge upon having been harmed,
How can this reverse the harm done?
Accordingly, revenge is useless for this life,
And counterproductive with regard to the next.

The result of earlier non-virtuous action,
Is regarded as having been called purification [by the Buddha].
[Yet] you harm the other. The suffering from that anger,
Is what you now proceed to sow.

Because getting angry at a bodhisattva,
One hundred kalpas' virtue accumulated through generosity and discipline,
Is destroyed in an instant.
Therefore, an evil worse than anger does not exist.

It creates an ugly body and leads to the unholy,
Robbed of discriminating mind,
Impatience will hurl you into the lower realms –
Patience remedies the above and develops qualities.

Through patience [you will be] beautiful;
Adored by holy beings; skilful in
Discerning right and wrong; and thereafter
Born as a human or god, you will exhaust evil.

Ordinary individuals and bodhisattvas,
Knowing the defects and qualities of anger and patience,
Abandon impatience and rely on
Patience as praised by Superiors.

Dedicating to perfect enlightened buddhahood,
With threefold reference is ordinary paramita.
If non-referential, the Buddha
Taught this to be transcendent paramita.

On this bhumi the bodhisattva [attains] samadhi and foreknowledge,
Exhausting entirely desire and anger.
And is always able to overcome
This world's gross attachment to desire.

These general practices – generosity and so forth –

The Sugata advocated for householders.
[These] known as the accumulations of merit,
Are seeds of the body, containing the Buddha's form.

The bodhisattva who is the radiance of the sun,
First completely dispels his own darkness,
He then wishes to dispel the darkness of sentient beings.
On this bhumi, though very sharp, he knows no aggression.

4. DAZZLING WITH LIGHT

All qualities depend on diligence –
Cause of the two accumulations of merit and wisdom.
Blazing with diligence,
The fourth bhumi is known as Radiant.

Here the bodhisattva's radiance
From thoroughly meditating on the aspects of buddhahood,
Shines brighter than copper.
Belief in self and its effects are exhausted.

5. DIFFICULT TO OVERCOME

All the demons of self-importance,
Cannot defeat the [bodhisattva] on the bhumi Difficult to Overcome:
Meditation is excellent, mind is good, the nature of truth
Is thoroughly realised, thus he becomes skilful.

6. KNOWING CLEARLY

In 'Advancing' his mind dwells in meditation,
Advancing towards the dharma of perfect buddhahood.
Seeing the suchness of dependent arising,
[The bodhisattva] dwells in wisdom, thereby reaching cessation.

As an entire crowd of blind people
Can easily be led to their desired destination
By a seeing individual, likewise intelligence
Can lead the blind qualities to victory.

The one who realised the profound dharma of this [bhumi],
Through the scriptures as well as through reasoning
Was Arya Nagarjuna. Based on his scriptural tradition,
I shall explain this tradition, as it exists today.

Even an ordinary being may, when hearing of emptiness,
Repeatedly feel immense joy surging within,
Bringing forth tears that moisten his eyes,
And making the hairs on his body quiver.

He has the seed for the mind of perfect enlightenment
And is a perfect recipient for instruction,
He must be taught the ultimate truth.
So the resulting qualities will arise.

Applying at all times perfect discipline, he comes to abide therein.
Giving with generosity, adhering to compassion,
And meditating on patience,
He completely dedicates his virtue to beings' enlightenment.

Devoted to the perfect bodhisattvas,
Skilled in the ways of the profound and the vast,
He will gradually attain the bhumi of Extremely Joyful.
Therefore, those aspiring thus should hear of this path.

Not created by itself, how can it be created by another?
Not created by both, what exists without a cause?
There is no purpose in something already arisen arising again.
What is already arisen cannot arise again.

If you truly believe something already created could recreate,
Production such as germination could not occur in ordinary experience.
Or a seed would continue to recreate until the end of existence –
What [sprout] would ever cause it to cease?

A sprout different from its instigating seed – with a distinct form,

Colour, flavour, potency and ripening – could then not exist.
If the self-substance of the previous vanishes,
As it assumes another nature, what remains of its suchness?

If in ordinary experience seed is not different from sprout,
You could have perception of neither seed nor sprout.
And, if they were the same, when seeing the sprout,
You should also see the seed. Thus, your thesis is unacceptable.

Because a result is seen upon disappearance of the cause,
To say they are the same is not accepted even in ordinary experience.
So-called creation from a self, when properly investigated
Is impossible, in suchness as well as ordinary experience.

If creation arises from a self, it follows that the created, the creator,
The act and the agent all are the same.
As these are not one, this ascertainment is impossible,
As there will follow the shortcomings already extensively explained.

Were something to be created based on something other than itself,
You could have deep darkness arising from a flame.
Anything could arise from anything,
As anything [that is] not the creating agent would be equally other.

[Objection:] Perfectly capable of being created [by other], it is certainly called the effect,
Capable of creating, although other, it is indeed the cause.
Contained within the same continuum and created by its creator,
It is not as if rice could sprout from barley.

[Reply:] Barley, lotus, the kimshuka flower, and so forth,
Are neither regarded as creators of the rice sprout, nor as having that potential,
Nor being of the same continuum, nor as being similar –
In that same [fourfold] manner, a rice seed too is other.

Since the sprout and the seed do not exist simultaneously,
There cannot be otherness. So how can the seed be other?
Thus, as creation of sprout from seed is not established,
Reject this premise of production from other.

[O:] Like the arms of a pair of scales,
Rising and descending simultaneously,

Creation arises as the creator ceases.

[A:] If simultaneous, but this is not the case.

When arising, still in the process of production, it is non-existent.

When ceasing, although in the process of disintegration, it still exists.

How does this compare to the movement of a pair of scales?

And with no agent of creation, this makes no sense at all.

[O:] Eye consciousness existing simultaneously with its creators:

Eye and [form] along with consciousness and [perception],

[Does indeed] exist as other. [A:] Then what is the need for the arising of the already existent?

[O:] It is not yet existent. [A:] In that case, the defects have already been explained.

If a creator is the cause of creating something other,

Is [the effect] existent? Non-existent? Or both? Or neither?

If existent, why a producer. If non-existent, what is created?

If both, or neither, what could create it?

Whoever holds a normal viewpoint, accepts ordinary experience as valid,

What is the need here for analytical view?

Creation from other is commonly accepted.

Therefore, creation from other exist. What need for reasoning?

[R:] All entities can be seen truly or deceptively,

So, whatever there is has two natures:

The domain of perfect seeing is suchness;

False seeing has been termed all-concealing truth [by the Buddha].

Again, for deceptive seeing one considers two:

That of clear faculties and that of impaired faculties.

Perception by impaired faculties is considered mistaken,

Compared with that of healthy faculties.

Whatever the six unimpaired faculties

Perceive in [unanalysed] ordinary experience,

Are true for ordinary experience alone; other perceptions

Are deluded in terms of ordinary experience.

Also in ordinary experience there are neither a

Fundamental nature as construed by the

The tirthikas (who are severely afflicted by the sleep of ignorance);
Nor phenomena such as illusions and mirages.

What is seen by someone with dimmed eyesight,
Cannot contradict what is seen by someone with good eyesight.
Likewise, a mind lacking immaculate wisdom,
Cannot contradict a mind possessing immaculate wisdom.

Because of obscuring ignorance, the nature [of all phenomena] is concealed.
What makes the artificial appear true
The Muni named all-concealing truth.
Thus, artificial entities are mere all-concealers.

Due to disease of the eye, hairs and so forth
May be perceived erroneously.
With a healthy eye, the actual nature is seen,
You should know suchness in this way (here).

If ordinary experience was valid,
One could perceive suchness within ordinary experience.
What need for Superiors? What need for the path of Superiors?
Thus, to rely on the foolish is senseless.

In no aspect is ordinary experience [ultimately] valid,
Therefore, ordinary experience does not contradict ultimate truth.
The phenomena of ordinary experience are accepted by ordinary experience,
Any denial of these would be contradicted.

An ordinary [person] who merely has sown his seed,
Will exclaim: "I created this child!"
People also think: "I planted this tree!"
Hence, even in ordinary experience is there no creation from other.

Because a sprout is not other than the seed,
At the time of the sprout, there is no destruction of the seed.
Because they are also not one,
At the time of the sprout, you cannot say a seed exists.

If inherent characteristics were the basis [of phenomena],
[Phenomena] would be destroyed through refutation [of their inherent characteristics]
And emptiness would become the cause of these entities' destruction.

As this is absurd, entities do not inherently exist.

Were you to analyse these objects,
Apart from the actual entity of the absolute,
Nothing enduring is found; thus the truth
Of conventional ordinary experience is not to be analysed.

With the analysis of suchness
Neither creation from self nor from other is possible;
It is not feasible even conventionally.
Now what happens to your creation?

Empty things such as reflections,
Namely composites – are [generally] accepted.
Likewise, from something empty, such as a reflection,
Consciousness of its characteristics may be created.

Similarly, while all entities may be empty,
They are fully created from [their] emptinesses.
Because in the two truths there is no inherent nature,
There is neither eternalism nor nihilism.

Because [an action] does not inherently cease,
And although there is no all-ground, an action is able [to produce a result].
A long time may have passed since the completion of an action,
Yet know that it will still manifest a result.

After seeing objects in a dream,
Upon awakening, a fool is still attached.
Likewise, actions terminated and without self-existence,
Still manifest results.

While objects may be as non-existing,
Someone with diseased eyes may perceive floating hairs,
But not other [non-existent] forms.
Similarly, know there is no repeated maturation.

Although seeing the non-virtuous ripening [that arises from] black deeds;
And the virtuous ripening [that arises from] virtue [as empty],
Liberation is achieved by a mind free from good and evil.
Speculation about the consequences of action was discouraged [by the Buddha].

“Existence of an all-ground”; “an existing individual”;
“Merely the skandhas exist”, –
Such instructions address those for whom the profound teachings
Are incomprehensible.

Although free from the view of transitory collection,
The Buddha still would say “I” and “my teaching”.
Likewise, while things have no inherent nature,
In the context of expedient truth, he spoke of a [relative] existence.

[Objection:] Without object, and no subject to be seen,
The three-fold world is fully realised as consciousness alone.
Thus, the Bodhisattva dwells in wisdom,
Realising mere consciousness as suchness.

As wind agitates the sea
Stirring up waves on the water surface,
From the seed of all, so-called all-ground,
Mere consciousness arises through its own potential.

Therefore the essence of the dependent nature,
Becomes the cause of the imputed existence of phenomena.
Manifesting, with nothing to grasp externally;
Inherently existing, it is not the domain of elaborations about existence.

[Reply:] Is there an example of an [intrinsic] mind without an object?
You say: “As in a dream”, but when I look
At my mind when it is dreaming,
It has no [intrinsic] existence. Hence, you have no valid example.

If there is memory of the dream when awakening,
And that mind exists, then the external objects [of the dream] should exist in the same
way,
Because remembering [the dream], you may think, “I saw”.
In the same way, the external world [of the dream] should also exist [when awake]

[Objection:] While sleeping there is no eye consciousness,
In the absence of [external objects], there is only mind consciousness
Whose manifestations are grasped as external.
As in the dream, so it is [when awake].

[Reply:] However, just as external phenomena in your dreams are unborn
Likewise, mind too is unborn.
The eye, its object, and the mind they create-
All three are false.

These three are also false in regard to hearing and so forth.
As in dreams, so also in this waking state
Their phenomena are false - there is no mind,
No objects, and no sense-faculties.

In ordinary experience, just as while awake,
While sleeping, these [above] three seem to exist;
Once awake they do not.
Awakening from the sleep of ignorance is similar.

[Objection:] The consciousness of someone with diseased eyesight,
And the floating hairs that appear due to that disease [do exist as non-external
phenomena].
[Reply:] These both are true for that mind,
But for the clear-seeing both are false.

If there is an awareness without object,
Then for those lacking what connects the eye and the hair – the disease –
Strands of hair should also appear.
As this is not the case, such an awareness cannot be established.

[Objection:] For someone with healthy eyesight,
Mental potential has merely not ripened; for this reason, they see nothing,
Not because a perceived object is lacking.
[Reply:] But potential does not exist; therefore, this cannot be established.

The already created does not have potential,
Likewise, the uncreated essence has no potential.
When a characteristic does not exist, there cannot be any possessor of such
characteristic,
Otherwise, it would also exist for a barren woman's child.

If you explain this [potential] as giving rise to [perception],
In the absence of potential, nothing will arise,
As objects that are mutually dependent,

The holy ones ascertain to be without intrinsic nature.

If [consciousness] were to arise due to the ripening of an already ceased potential,
Then from the potential [of one consciousness] a different [consciousness] could arise.
However, if [the successive elements of] a continuity were separate,
Anything could thus arise from anything.

If you claim that the separate (elements) of a continuity,
Partake in a non-separate continuity, and therefore
There is no fault, this remains to be established.
As a non-separate continuity is impossible.

The phenomena particular to Maitreya and Upagupta
Are different and not of one continuity.
Phenomena possessing their own particular characteristics
Therefore cannot be a single continuity.

[Objection:] Eye consciousness' own potential for production
May create anything, as explained above.
And through that potential, based on its own consciousness,
Arises the concept of the eye, the form-perceiving faculty.

In ordinary experience perceptions arise from the senses -
Without there being objects, from their own cause,
Appearances such as blue and so forth arise. Those without realisation
Accept these exterior objects of the mind.

In a dream the perceived forms are not external –
They arise from the maturation of their own potential, within the perceiving mind.
Likewise, when we awaken,
There exists a non-external external mind.

[Reply:] As in the dream-state, without [the organ of] the eye,
Mental cognition of colours does occur.
Accordingly, in the absence of the eye-senses, the actual seed [of consciousness]
Maturing, why should visual perception not occur to the blind?

If the potential of the sixth [consciousness] matures in the dream,
And disappears upon awakening,
If this potential of the sixth [consciousness] thus does not exist [when the blind person awakes],

Why should it exist when he is dreaming?

Thus the absence of eyes is not the cause,
And for dreams, sleep is not the cause.
You must concede that even in dreams, things [perceived] and the [perceiving] eye,
Are causes for the conception of a false subject.

As the Cittamatrīn answers and statements
Seem to be [mere] propositions,
The dispute is settled. The Buddha has never taught
That anything inherently exists.

A yogin meditating on the instructions of his teacher
Sees the earth as covered in bones.
Still the three he sees are uncreated,
And this is taught to be false conceptualisation.

Just as whatever mental objects you may have,
Such as [meditation on] ugly mental images,
Merely focusing the mind [on them],
[The concept of them] should make them real.

Similarly, as someone afflicted with a visual aberration,
A hungry ghost will experience a running river as pus.
In brief, in the absence of an object,
There is also no intellect. Know this as true.

Without an object, and free from a subject –
If a dependent nature free from duality were to exist [inherently],
What could recognise its existence?
Not being an object [of a mind], its existence cannot be claimed

Something experiencing itself cannot be established.
You may argue that a later memory validates it,
Yet, as [memory] in itself remains to be established [as inherently existing],
It cannot serve as valid proof.

An own awareness can indeed be experienced,
Yet, since a memory of a memory is unseen,
It would be like something alien and never known arising in the mind.
This reasoning vanquishes all the others.

According to our tradition,
Because memory is not other than that which experiences an object,
It is the memory that thinks, “I saw”.
This agrees with conventional ordinary experience.

Therefore, as self-awareness cannot exist,
What perceives your dependent nature?
As the agent, the action, and the object cannot be one,
Experience of itself cannot be possible.

If, without being neither born nor known,
An inherently real dependent-nature would exist.
Its existence would be illogical.
What did the barren woman’s child do to you?

When the dependent does not exist even the least,
How can it cause all-concealment?
Our opponent, through his attachment to substance,
Destroys the categories of accepted ordinary experience.

Apart from this very path of the venerable Acharya Nagarjuna,
Other paths will not serve as means to attain Peace,
As they incompletely [grasp] the all-concealing and absolute truths;
They fail to establish liberation.

Conventional truth is the means;
Absolute truth is the aim.
Whoever is unaware of this distinction
Will enter inferior paths because of wrong conceptions.

This dependent nature which you assert as real,
We do not accept even as an all-concealing [truth].
[On the other hand], for the sake of the [ultimate] fruit, we have stated the non-existent
exists,
[Merely] to conform to ordinary experience.

If, just as for the arhats
Who have abandoned the aggregates and dwell in peace,
The [aggregates] would not exist in ordinary experience,
I also would not claim they exist in ordinary experience.

If you [think you] do not contradict ordinary experience,
[Then try] refuting ordinary people.
You should debate with [those perceiving] ordinary experience,
And I will rely on whoever is the stronger.

The Courageous Mind advancing towards realisation
Realises the three worlds as mere consciousness.
This refutes a permanent self as creator,
[And he] realises the creator is “mind only.

In order to increase the faculties of the intelligent,
And to cut through [misconceptions],
The Omniscient One in the Lankavatara Sutra
Vanquished the towering mountain[-like view] of the tirthikas with his vajra speech.

In their treatises,
The tirthikas propound a person and so forth [as a creator];
Not having seen such a creator,
The Victorious One spoke of the creator of the world as being mind only.

Just as Awakened to Suchness refers to the Awakened One,
When in some sutras [the Buddha] spoke of “mind only”
When speaking to the world about mind’s importance,
The point of these sutras was not to deny form.

If his intention was to say all this is mind only,
When he refuted [external] form in the sutra,
Why did the Great Being also in that [same] sutra
State that mind is produced from ignorance and action.

The vast multiplicity of sentient life,
And the enveloping physical world springs from mind.
The Buddha taught sentient beings arise from karma,
So without mind, karma could not exist.

Form does indeed exist,
[Yet] it is not a creator like mind.
A creator other than mind is denied,
Not the existence of form.

According to the truth of ordinary experience,
The five skandhas exist as commonly accepted.
To the yogi for whom the wisdom of suchness arises,
None of the five appear.

If form does not exist, do not maintain mind exists.
If mind exists, do not maintain non-existence of form.
Thus in the Prajñāparamita [mind and form] were equally refuted,
[While] in the Abhidharma [they were equally accepted].

Even though these two levels of truth are dismantled,
Your substantial [other-dependent phenomena] cannot be proven as this was already
refuted.
Therefore, for these levels reality is originally
Uncreated according to suchness, while created according to ordinary experience.

The sutra teaches external appearances are non-existent,
And that mind manifests in diverse ways.
For those with strong attachment to form,
Such expedient truth repels [fixation on] form.

The teacher taught this is expedient meaning,
Which is also [proven] logically.
Like [in the Lankavatara Sutra] other sutras too [the Sutra Unravelling the thought]
Elucidate the expedient meaning.

The Buddhas taught that with non-existence of object,
Elimination of knower is easily achieved.
Without object the perceiver is disproven,
And therefore, objects were first refuted.

To know the categories of the scriptures,
Understand that sutras explaining other than the meaning of suchness,
Teach expedient truth, – these are to be interpreted,
While those explaining emptiness teach certain truth.

Creation from both [self and other] is also not reasonable,
As the defects already explained would arise;
[Such creation] accords with neither ordinary experience nor suchness,
As creation from neither [self nor other] could be proven.

If creation had no cause whatsoever,
Everything could arise from anything.
To have a harvest, there would be no need as usual
For the hundreds of things such as gathering the seeds.

If sentient beings were void of any cause,
Then, as the colour and scent of a sky-utpala, they could not be perceived.
Yet as ordinary experience is perceived vividly,
Know that just like mind, the ordinary experience arises from causes.

These elements you conceive as a primary nature.
Yet they possess no such nature.
How could someone with such thick mental obscuration
Ever properly know what is beyond [this life]?

When refuting that beyond ordinary experience,
You are mistakenly viewing the self as having the nature of an object,
Because you base your view on the physical body.
Just as when you assert the elements as having an inherent self.

Discussion of the existence or non-existence of the elements has already been
completed,
Because [creation] from self, other, or both as cause,
As well as uncaused creation, has been generally refuted.
Therefore, without a [specific] discussion the elements have no [inherent] existence.

Because no [phenomena] are created from self, from other, from both,
Or independent of a cause, all things are without inherent [existence].
Due to the dense clouds of ignorance enveloping ordinary experience
Objects appear in a deceptive way.

Due to disorders of the eye, some mistakenly perceive hairs, double moons
Eyes of the peacock's feathers and honeybees.
Similarly, due to the defect of ignorance, the minds of the unskilful
Perceive merely a variety of composite [phenomena].

That karma is based on ignorance, while without ignorance
[Karma] is said not to arise, is exclusively a belief held by the unwise.
The sun of their excellent minds perfectly clearing away obscurity,
The wise comprehend emptiness and are liberated.

[Objection:] If all things were non-existent in suchness,
Then even conventionally they would be like a barren woman's child.
This is not the case, and therefore
Things must [inherently] exist.

[Reply:] Try first arguing a little
With those afflicted by cataracts
Who perceive unproduced floating hairs and so forth,
And then later with those afflicted by the cataracts of ignorance.

If you can see that a dream, a gandharva city,
A mirage, a hallucination, a reflection and so forth,
Are [truly] uncreated, and as if non-existent,
Why do you insist [phenomena consequently] could not be seen.

If in suchness these [similes] are uncreated,
Why in ordinary experience, are they not as a child of a barren woman,
Something unseen?
Therefore, this [objection] is not definitive.

The [intrinsic] creation of a barren woman's child,
Exists neither in suchness, nor in ordinary experience.
Such is the nature of all entities –
Neither in suchness nor ordinary experience are they created.

For this reason the Teacher said all phenomena
Are primordially peaceful, uncreated,
And naturally beyond suffering.
For this reason, there is never any creation.

While vases and the like do not exist in suchness,
Look how they exist so commonly in ordinary experience.
Likewise, it does not follow that all things
Are like a child of a barren woman.

Because neither uncaused, nor caused by God,
[Caused by] itself, another or both,
There exists no phenomenon that is [inherently] produced,
And therefore [phenomena] are fully created in dependence.

Because things are completely [inter-] dependent,

These [extreme] beliefs remain powerless.
And for this reason the reasoning of interdependent origination
Is what cuts through the variety inferior views.

Conceptions occur if things have an existence,
Yet how things have no existence has already been decided.
Being non-existent, these [extreme beliefs] will not occur, as for example
Without firewood, you will have no fire.

Ordinary beings are fettered by thoughts;
Yogis are freed through non-thought.
Therefore, to [recognise] that thoughts are erroneous
Is the outcome of analysis. So the wise have said.

Analysis in the treatises does not come from fascination with polemics
Suchness is shown for the sake of [attaining] liberation.
If suchness is fully explained,
And [the views] of opposing scriptures will come apart, this is not [our] fault.

Clinging to one's own view and equally
Assailing the views of others, such are [limited] attitudes.
Therefore, when first clinging and hatred have been cleared away,
Analysis will bring liberation.

Understanding that all afflictions and defects
Arise from the view of the transitory collection –
Realising self is the object of this [view],
The yogi terminates such a self.

The tirthikas assert a [self] to be an experiencer, permanent substance, noncreative,
Non-possessor of the [three] qualities, and inactive.
Based on minor differences,
The tirthikas themselves have different traditions.

Uncreated like a barren woman's child,
Such a self is non-existent.
Not acceptable as basis for I-fixation,
It cannot even be considered an all-concealer.

The characteristics [of self] mentioned in the various scriptures
Of the tirthikas,

Are contradicted by the tirthikas themselves with their reasoning of noncreation,
Rendering non-existent these characteristics.

Thus a self distinct from the aggregates cannot be,
Because apart from the aggregates, there is nothing to fixate on.
Ordinary beings do not accept it as the basis of fixating on I,
Because although they do not perceive it there is still view of a self.

Those born as animals for many aeons,
May never have seen this uncreated permanent [self].
Nevertheless, it is clear they cling to a self,
Therefore, other than the skandhas there can be no self.

As a self other than the aggregates is not established,
The focus of the view of self is solely the aggregates.
For the view of self, based on the skandhas,
Some see it as five-fold while some see it as a single mind.

If the aggregates were the self,
Being multiple, there should be multiple selves,
The self would be substantial,
And being substantial, [self] would be unmistaken.

At the time of nirvana there certainly would be no self.
Before nirvana, there would be creation and cessation [of self],
And without agent, there would be no consequence [of action],
And [action] accumulated by one [person] would be experienced by another.

[You hold] there is no fault having a continuity in the absolute,
[But] when earlier examined, the faults of a continuity were all explained.
Thus, that skandhas and mind should be a self is not feasible,
Because the end of the world and so forth was/were not discussed.

For a yogi who sees selflessness,
Entities will certainly disappear
If it is a permanent self that is abandoned,
[In that case] your mind or aggregates cannot be the self.

[Therefore] when a yogi sees selflessness,
He will not realise the suchness of form etc.
Observing a form, desire and so forth will arise

From not understanding its essence.

You may consider the skandhas to be the self,
Because the Teacher taught so,
[But] that was to refute that self is other than skandhas.
Other sutras state that form is not a self.

Self is not form, nor feeling, nor perception,
Nor formation, nor consciousness,
Because of the negations in various sutras,
It is simply not taught skandhas are the self.

When it is said skandhas are the self,
It is the skandhas as a gathering, and not the individual skandha.
Not a protector, not a tamer and not a witness.
Not being these, the gathering cannot be [a self].

Because a variety of parts
Make up a chariot, the self is comparable to a chariot.
The sutras teach [imputation of self] is based on the skandhas,
Therefore, [self] is merely a gathering, not a [true] self.

Because shape exists in [the skandha of] form,
You call this a self;
But the mental skandhas cannot be a self,
Because they do not possess shapes.

That perpetuator and action should be one is illogical,
Were it so, action and agent would be identical.
If you think there can be action without agent,
This is not so. Without actor, there is no action.

A self depends on earth, water, fire,
Wind, consciousness and sky,
The six faculties, the [senses such as] the eyes, and the bases of contact,
This the Sage clearly taught.

[A self bases itself on] mind, mental events and dharmas –
[This the Buddha] ascertained. [A self] is not other than these,
It is not the same, neither is it their gathering.
Thus, fixation on I is in neither of these minds.

Realising a selflessness that refutes a permanent self,
Cannot be considered [refuting] a basis for I fixation.
That such cognition of egolessness
Should uproot the view of the transitory collection as a self is indeed an astonishing statement.

As when discovering a snake's nest in the wall of one's home,
And comforting oneself that it is not an elephant,
Besides relieving fear of the snake
Alas! One is the laughing stock of others.

Neither does the self dwell in the skandhas, nor is it in the self
The skandhas dwell. For this reason,
Were they different this could be conceivable,
But not being different, this is a [mistaken] notion.

The self cannot be considered to possess form, because a self
Does not exist and hence the idea of possession does not apply.
[Applies if] they are different, as in possessing a cow; or identical, as in possessing a body.
The self is neither form nor different.

Form is not a self and self does not possess form;
Form does not exist in a self and self does not exist in form.
The four [other] skandhas too are like this,
These are the twenty views of a self.

The mountain [-like] view [of an inherently existing self] is destroyed by the
[wisdom]-vajra of realising selflessness.
Simultaneously with this are also destroyed
The strong mountains of the view of the transitory collection,
The towering peaks [of the twenty views of transitory collection].

Some [hold] an indescribable substantial person
With identical or different, permanent or impermanent self and skandhas.
[Such a self] can be seen as an object of the six consciousnesses,
And is regarded as the ground of I-fixation.

Because the difference between form and mind is not indescribable,
And [something] real and existing is not perceived as indescribable.

Were someone to prove a real self,
Being a proven reality like the mind, it would not be indescribable.

Because you [claim] the nature of a pot does not exist substantially,
As one cannot describe its form and so forth [as different or identical],
A self and skandhas being [equally] indescribable,
[Does not let you view] self as inherently existing / You cannot view self as inherently existing.

You do not regard consciousness as different from itself,
But you do regard it as an entity different from the skandhas.
Because entities are regarded as having these aspects [of identity or difference],
[But here] not having these [two] characteristics of entities, there is no self.

Therefore the basis for fixating on a self is not an entity,
It is not other than the skandhas, nor is it the skandhas themselves;
It is neither based on the skandhas, nor does [it] possess them.
[Rather, self] is established in dependence on the skandhas.

Similarly, we cannot consider a chariot as being other than its parts;
Nor identical; nor possessing these;
It is not in the parts; nor are the parts in it;
It is not the mere collection; and it is not their shape.

If a mere collection [of the parts] were the chariot,
The disassembled parts should too be the chariot.
But that the parts, without a part-possessor,
Or even the mere shape should be the chariot, is absurd.

You claim the original shape is still in the individual parts,
Even [now] when the chariot is assembled.
Thus, as it did not exist when the parts were unassembled
The chariot does not exist now either.

Now, when there is a chariot
If the wheels etc. exist differently,
This should be perceived, yet it is not.
Thus, the chariot cannot exist in mere shape.

Because your [substantial] collection is non-existent,
Shape is not a collection of parts.

Therefore, based on nothing,
How can you have a shape?

According to your own thesis
Of the manifest result being untrue,
You should know it must be based on a false cause,
And that all creation is likewise.

Consequently, it applies to all those ascertaining the eight atoms,
That their thought of vase is absurd,
Since without creation, the eight atoms also cannot exist,
And therefore [objects] cannot exist as the shape.

Indeed, neither in suchness nor in ordinary experience, is such [phenomena],
Established according to the sevenfold analysis.
Yet in this world without analysis,
Based on their parts, things are dependently imputed.

Having parts which again have details,
A chariot is regarded by everyone as possessing itself.
Beings exist as possessing themselves.
Do not demolish the all-concealer accepted in ordinary experience.

How can something not existing in this seven-fold way then exist?
The yogi not finding anything,
Will easily enter suchness.
However, understand it [also] exists just [unanalysed].

When there is no existence of a chariot,
Without the whole, the parts also do not exist.
For example, if a chariot burns up there are no parts,
When the fire of knowledge incinerates the whole, the parts [are burned] too.

Likewise as in accepted ordinary experience, based on the aggregates,
The elements, and the six sense-spheres,
The self is considered the proprietor.
The appropriation is the action while [self] is the agent.

Not substantially [existing], [self] is not unchanging,
Not arising and ceasing, not changeable,
Not [characterised] by permanence or any other extreme,

Not identical, and not different [from the skandhas].

In reference to [the ground]

Which sentient beings always strongly grasp as an I,
Arises the self of the mind fixating on 'mine',
It arises from ignorance [in terms of] unanalysed accepted [ordinary experience]

Because without agent there is no action,
Therefore, with no self, there is no 'mine'.
And therefore seeing self and mine as empty,
The yogin is fully liberated.

Vases, cloth, tents, armies, forests, garlands, trees,
Houses, carts, inns and so forth, whatever things there may be,
Accordingly, [as these things appear] to ordinary persons, accept them as such,
Because the Lord of the Sages did not argue with ordinary experience.

Parts and whole, qualities and qualifiers, passion and the impassioned,
Description and described, firewood and fire, all such objects –
When subjected to the analysis of the chariot, in all seven aspects, have no existence.
Otherwise, in terms of accepted ordinary experience, they do exist.

[Only] if you see a cause creating something is it a cause;
When no result is created, there cannot be a cause.
If the result has a cause, it exists, therefore
Tell us, which gives rise to which, and which is first?

According to you, if a result is created from meeting the cause,
With identical potential, cause and result would not be different.
With different potential, causes and non-causes would not be distinguishable.
Therefore, with these two refuted, there can be no further alternative.

If your cause does not create a result, the result cannot exist as an object,
A cause without a result, not being a cause, is even non-existent.
Because these both resemble illusions
I am not at fault, accepting the entities of ordinary experience as existent.

[Objection:] Does this refutation meet with what it refutes or not.
Doesn't the [refuted] fault apply to you?
Whenever voicing [such refutation] you merely defeat yourself,
And your refutation has no power to refute anything.

Because the consequence of your words is deceptive,
They are absurd. And as they negate things real
You will not be accepted by the holy.
As you have no position, your refutations are random confrontation.

[Reply:] Whether or not the refutation touches
What is to be refuted – the fallacy in question
Befalls those taking the positions of true [existence],
But not myself, as I have no position.

Just as you may perceive the sun
Reflected during an eclipse,
[Thinking of] whether or not sun and reflection touch,
Is absurd, as [the reflection] arises as a conventional dependent.

While a reflection [in a mirror] is not real,
You rely on it to make yourself attractive.
Likewise understand that although unusual, [Madhyamika] reasoning
Will clean the face of wisdom, bringing realisation of the goal.

If our predicate and its reasoning – the means for understanding – were established as real,
And likewise the nature of our predicate— the object to be understood—
The [above] logic of contact would apply [to ourselves].
This is not the case, so you are merely exhausting yourself.

Making [others] realise that all entities have no reality is easy,
However to make us believe in an [inherent] nature
Is not simple at all.
Why entangle ordinary people in webs of false logic?

Understanding the refutations given above,
You should then forget [these arguments] about contact, [made exclusively] for the
opponent,
And not mere random confrontations.
These statements should be understood by the opponent.

In order to liberate sentient beings,
The two divisions of individual and phenomenal selflessness were taught.
Accordingly, the teacher repeatedly taught this point

In various ways for various trainees.

When elaborate, of emptinesses
He taught sixteen, when brief
He taught four – all these
Are also taught to be the Mahayana.

Because its nature is [non-inherent]
Eyes are empty of eyes
Likewise the ears, the nose, the tongue
Body and mind too are explained as such.

Not continuously dwelling, and also not disintegrating –
The six senses, eyes and so forth,
Are without inherent existence.
This is regarded as emptiness of inner.

Because of its nature,
Form is empty of form.
Likewise sound, scent, taste and touch:
All phenomena are so.

Form and so forth have no inherent nature,
This is outer emptiness.
The absence of inherent existence in both [outer and inner phenomena],
Is emptiness of outer and inner.

All phenomena's lack of inherent existence,
Is explained as emptiness by the wise.
That emptiness also,
Is regarded as being empty of any essence.

The emptiness of that known as emptiness,
Is known as emptiness of emptiness,
And was taught to avert the fixation
Of those holding emptiness as real.

Pervading without exception
All sentient beings and the outer world,
Without limits, as in the [Four] Boundless,
The directions [of space] are vast.

In the tenfold entirety of [of space],
The directions are empty.
This is the emptiness of vastness
Taught to avert fixation on vastness.

Being the supreme goal,
The ultimate is nirvana.
The emptiness of it,
Is the emptiness of absolute.

To avert fixation
Of those holding nirvana as an entity,
Absolute wisdom was taught as
The emptiness of absolute.

Arising from conditions,
The three worlds were certainly explained as compounded.
The emptiness of this
Was taught as emptiness of the compounded.

[All phenomena] are created, dwell and are impermanent,
Are [inherently] non-existent, thus being uncompounded.
This emptiness
Is emptiness of the uncompounded.

Whatever has no limitations
Is said to be beyond limits;
It is in itself emptiness,
Explained as emptiness of the limitless.

Because the two extremes of beginning and end
Do not exist, samsara
Is said to be without beginning or end –
With neither coming nor going, like a dream.

Therefore samsara is said to be empty of itself,
Without beginning and end,
It is known as empty.
As explained with certainty in the scriptures [of Prajñaparamita].

To discard means to disperse,
To throw out – so it is firmly defined.
To retain is to not discard,
[Mahayana] is what is never discarded.

The non-discarded suchness
Which is empty of suchness,
Is therefore
Called the emptiness of non-discarding.

The essence of the composite –
Has not been fabricated
By the [shravaka-] disciples, the pratyekabuddhas,
The bodhisattvas or the buddhas.

Therefore the essence [of compounded and uncompounded],
Were explained [as empty].
By way of suchness,
Inherently empty.

The eighteen constituents, the six senses,
The related six perceptions,
Form and formless,
All compounded and uncompounded dharmas –

All these phenomena,
Are empty of themselves.
The emptiness of insubstantial [phenomena], including form,
Is the emptiness of characteristics.

Form has the characteristics of taking form;
Feeling is the experiencer;
Perception perceives attributes;
Formation actually gathers [causes and conditions];

Perceiving each particular object,
Is the specific characteristic of consciousness.
Suffering is the specific characteristic of the skandhas,
The characteristics of the constituents are like a venomous snake.

The senses, so the Buddha taught,

Are the sources of creation.
Being interdependently connected
Is the characteristic of the conditioned.

Giving is the paramita of generosity;
Discipline is the absence of anguish;
Patience is the absence of anger;
Endeavour is the absence of regret.

Meditation has the characteristic of concentration;
Wisdom has the characteristic of non-attachment;
The six-fold paramitas
Have been described as such.

The [four] samadhis, the [four] boundless,
And others such as the [four] formless –
With his wisdom of perfect knowledge
He taught these as having the characteristic of immutability.

The thirty-seven limbs of enlightenment
Have the characteristic of accomplishing certain [liberation].
The characteristic of [the first door of perfect liberation], emptiness,
Is the absence of entities through the non-existence of objectification [as truly existing];

The [second], the absence of characteristics is peace;
And the characteristic of the third, [wishlessness],
Is absence of suffering and ignorance.
Such are the characteristics of the instigators of liberation.

The nature of the [ten] powers
Was completely established [by the Buddha].
The protecting fearlessnesses,
Are in essence extreme stability.

The perfect [types of] comprehension of particulars,
Such as memory, have the nature of immeasurability.
To perfectly accomplish the benefit of sentient beings
Is known as great loving-kindness;

To fully protect those suffering,
Is great compassion;

[Sympathetic] joy has the nature of joy.
Equanimity is known as being unpolluted.

By having a buddha's uncommon dharma,
Ten and eightfold,
The Teacher was unmistaken,
Having the characteristic of being unmistaken.

The wisdom of omniscience
Is considered to have the characteristic of being direct.
On the contrary, fleeting [cognition]
Is not considered direct.

The characteristics of the compounded and
The characteristics of the uncompounded,
Are in suchness emptiness;
Their own characteristic is suchness.

The present does not remain;
Past and future do not exist –
With no observation of these
They are known as non-referential.

The essence of this non-referentiality
Is absent. This [absence] is
Not continuous, not dwelling, not perishable.
It is the emptiness of that known as the unapprehended.

Being created from circumstances,
All composite entities are without essence.
In suchness, the composite is empty –
The emptiness of the insubstantial.

The meaning of "entity" in brief
Is described as the five aggregates.
The emptiness of these,
Is taught as the emptiness of entities.

In summary, non-entity
Describes all uncompounded phenomena.
That emptiness of non-entities,

Is the emptiness of non-entity.

The absence of essence of a nature,
Is called the emptiness of nature.
Thus because nature is uncompounded,
It is called nature.

Whether buddhas appear,
Or do not appear, in reality,
The emptiness of entities
Is widely known as transcendent entity.

This is the perfect extreme, suchness,
Or the emptiness of transcendent entity.
According to Prajñāparamita,
These are the widely known [twenty emptinesses].

Through the illuminating light of wisdom,
As clear as a myrobalan fruit held in his own hand,
He realises the three worlds as originally uncreated,
And through conventional truth proceeds to cessation.

Even though his mind is always dwelling in cessation,
He generates compassion for unprotected sentient beings.
Later, all shravakas and pratyekabuddhas without exception
Will be defeated by his mind.

Spreading his broad wings of [the truths of] concealment and suchness,
Leading the swans of [ordinary] individuals, this king of swans,
Soars ahead on the strong winds of virtue,
And proceeds to the supreme far shore of the Victorious Ones' qualities.

7. GONE FAR

On [the bhumi of] Far Gone,
[The bodhisattva] enters cessation at any instant,
Brilliantly mastering the paramita of Upaya.

8. IMMOVABLE

In order to attain further increase of virtue,
The great lord enters The Immovable,
So that [virtue] becomes irreversible –
Here [the paramita of] aspiration is exceedingly pure,
And he is roused from cessation by the Victorious Ones.

Because a mind free from attachment cannot have any faults.
Defilements and their roots are fully pacified on the eighth bhumi.
While his afflictions are exhausted and he is the supreme of the three worlds,
Still [the bodhisattva] is unable to procure the limitless sky-like wealth of the buddhas.

Samsara has been stopped and as he attains the ten powers,
He will manifest in a variety of ways to sentient beings.

9. PERFECT INTELLIGENCE

On the ninth [bhumi] [the bodhisattva's] various strengths become perfectly purified,
And he attains the perfect purity of the qualities of [validly] cognising phenomenon.

10. CLOUD OF DHARMA

On the tenth bhumi [the bodhisattva] is empowered by all the buddhas,
Receiving holiness, his wisdom becomes even more supreme.
As from rain clouds, for the sake of sentient beings,
The sons of the victorious ones spontaneously rain down Dharma upon the crops of virtue.

CONCLUSION: QUALITIES OF BUDDHAHOOD

At this time [of the first bhumi], seeing one-hundred buddhas,
And understands he is blessed by them.
He remains for a hundred kalpas on this [bhumi],
Even the end of the last and the beginning of the next [kalpa] is perfectly perceived.

This Wise One enters and arises from a hundred samadhis;
He is capable of moving and illuminating a hundred worlds;
Likewise, he is miraculously able to bring a hundred beings to maturation,
And he is able to travel to as many buddha fields.

The Muni prince perfectly opens the doors of the Dharma,
Displaying within his single body one-hundred bodies,
And just as every body is endowed with its own entourage
Each of the one hundred has an equal display.

Such qualities of the Wise One dwelling on the pramudita bhumi,
Are perfectly achieved in exactly the same way, but thousand-fold
When he dwells on the [bhumi] of Stainless.
[In the following] five bhumis the bodhisattva achieves one hundred thousand
[qualities],

Then one billion, and then ten billion;
After that, he achieves one trillion followed by
Ten million trillions which again are
Multiplied thousand-fold, all of which he obtains completely.

Dwelling on the eighth bhumi, the Immovable [the bodhisattva] has no discursive
thoughts.
If one gathered a hundred thousand of the billion fold universe,
All the dust motes these contain
Would equal the amount of qualities he here achieves.

Dwelling on the [ninth] bhumi of Excellent Intelligence,
The bodhisattva achieves the previously mentioned [twelve] qualities
[Multiplied] by as many as ten times the dust motes
In a hundred thousand of the infinite [universe].

To say the least, qualities on the tenth [bhumi],

Exceed the reach of words.
Were one to describe the indescribable,
They are as many as there are motes of dust.

The bodhisattva is able to manifest at any moment,
In every pore of his body, bodhisattvas
Together with perfect buddhas, infinite in numbers,
As well as devas, asuras and humans.

As the moon shines brightly in a clear sky,
You strove repeatedly for the bhumi that develops the ten powers.
In the Akanishta buddhafield, you accomplished the aim of all efforts - the level of
supreme peace –
With its ultimate and incomparable qualities.

As the divisions of a container does not create different space,
Likewise, the various categories of phenomena do not divide suchness.
Therefore when perfectly comprehending one taste,
You excellent Wise One comprehended [everything] knowable in a single instant.

[Objection:] If peace is suchness, there is no engaging intellect.
With no engaging intellect, an apprehender of objects certainly makes no sense.
The absence of apprehender contradicts any cognition,
And without any cognition who can teach others, saying, "It is so"?

[Reply:] If the uncreated is suchness, [perceiving] mind too is uncreated
Therefore, realisation of suchness is realizing that nature.
As a mind that fully perceives an object
Knows it in conventional dependence.

Sambhogakaya is attained through [the Buddha's] merit,
And through emanations in the sky and other [locations]
He teaches the Dharma of suchness,
So even the world perceives suchness.

Just as when a strong potter
Spins his wheel for a long time to set it turning,
Later with no exertion of effort,
The turning is seen to cause a pot.

Likewise, without any effort at present

[The Buddha] resides as the embodied Lord of Dharma,
Through the virtues of ordinary beings, and his own extraordinary prayers,
His greatness being inconceivable.

When the dry firewood of everything knowable,
Is [consumed by the fire of wisdom], the peace of the victorious one's dharmakaya [is all
there remains]
At that moment, there is no creation and no cessation;
When mind ceases, its [enjoyment]-body manifests in actuality.

Motionless, yet this [enjoyment]-body illuminates as the wish-granting tree;
Non-conceptual as the wish-fulfilling jewel;
Permanent, furnishing comforts until [all] beings are liberated,
It manifests within simplicity.

Accordingly, the Muni Lord may in an instant
And in a single body manifest his previous births,
Although already ceased, and without effort,
He may display every possible detail.

The buddhafi elds; the buddha;
His actions and powers;
The number of shravaka sangha and their nature;
The bodhisattvas and their forms;

Which Dharma, how he himself was,
Which conduct he practised [as a result of] hearing the teaching;
Which offerings he made and how much were offered –
Without omissions, he can display all these.

Likewise, his [practice of] discipline, patience, diligence, samadhi
And wisdom, as he practised them
Flawlessly – all these actions,
He also displays within every pore of his body.

Also [he can display how] the buddhas of the past, those to come,
And those of the present will as long as the sky lasts,
With a penetrating voice show the truth so the afflicted
Beings may be liberated, and [how they themselves] remain in this world,

And from the first developing of bodhicitta until enlightenment,

How all their actions have a magical display's nature.
Knowing this and that we are likewise, in their pores
They will display all this clearly in a single instant.

Likewise the actions of the three times' bodhisattvas,
The pratyekabuddhas and all noble shravakas.
Beside those of ordinary individuals,
He can display simultaneously in every pore.

This Pure One, according to his will,
May display a single mote of dust as the entire universe,
And the infinite universe as a mote of dust,
Without the dust mote becoming any bigger or the universe any smaller.

Without thoughts, until the end of [cyclic] existence,
You can display as many actions as there are instants,
As infinite as there are worlds,
And dust motes within in these worlds.

The power of knowing what is and what is not origin; (1)
Likewise knowing the maturation of actions; (2)
Comprehension of various aspirations; (3)
The power of realizing various propensities; (4)

Likewise supreme and non-supreme faculties; (5)
The [paths of] knowledge and ordinariness; (6)
Concentrations, liberation, samadhis,
Absorptions – such mental powers; (7)

Knowledge of remembering the past; (8)
Knowledge of passing and birth; (9)
Knowledge of exhausting defilements; (10)
Such are the ten powers.

A cause that has created a certain thing,
The Knowing One has taught as the thing's basis,
Likewise, there are infinite objects that are not its basis.
This knowledge removes obstructions and is [the first] power.

Wanted and unwanted [karma], the opposite— the reality of exhaustion,
And the myriad of karmic ripening,

The capacity of unobstructedly knowing each of these objects,
Throughout the three times is [the second] power.

The intentions arisen from the strength of desire and so forth;
The vast multitude of lower, middling and supreme aspirations;
And other hidden aspirations – this knowledge
Covers every being of the three times, is [the third] power.

The buddhas, knowledgeable about the divisions of constituents,
Called the nature of the eyes and so forth constituents.
The infinite knowledge of the perfect buddhas,
Penetrates all aspects of phenomena. This is [the fourth] power.

Discursive thought and so forth may be supreme for the very sharp,
Yet not so for the middling and inferior, it was taught.
Comprehending how the eyes and so forth are established in mutuality,
Such is [the fifth] power of the desirelessness of omniscience.

The paths of buddhas, of pratyekabuddhas,
Of shravakas and of bodhisattvas; [the paths of] pretas,
Animals, gods, humans and the denizens of hell –
Unlimited and unobstructed knowledge of these is [the sixth] power.

The world's various yogin's different meditations
And eight liberations of shamatha,
And the single and eightfold absorptions –
Unobstructed knowledge of these is [the seventh] power.

When he himself was deluded and dwelling in samsara,
The cyclic existence of other sentient beings,
As infinite many as they are, their origins and countries,
Such knowledge and capacity is [the eighth] power.

The transmigration of every sentient being,
Their lives and their worlds, to the very limits of space –
Knowing the details and perceiving the time
Such unobstructed perfectly pure, infinite [knowledge] is [the ninth] power.

Through the power of omniscience, swiftly the buddha's
Kleshas are purified, destroyed together with their habitual patterns, and,
The afflictions of the disciples cease through intelligence,

Such infinite unobstructed knowledge, [the tenth] power.

It is not because there is no sky that birds turn back –
They turn back as their strength exhausts.
Likewise, together with their disciples, even the bodhisattvas,
Must relinquish describing the sky-like qualities of the buddhas.

Therefore, how can someone like me know of your qualities?
Or be able to describe them?
Yet, as noble Nagarjuna has explained these,
I have set aside hesitation to speak briefly on these.

The profound being emptiness,
The vast are the other qualities.
Through knowing the ways of the profound and vast,
These qualities will be accomplished.

After achieving the immutable kaya, you returned once again to the three worlds with emanations,
Descending, taking birth and showing the Dharma of attaining peaceful enlightenment.
Thus for all those subscribing to the deceits of the world,
Who are bound by those chains, through your compassion, you lead these beyond suffering.

Therefore, apart from knowing suchness, for removing the various stains
There is no other method, as phenomena know no divisions of suchness.
The mind that perceives suchness is also not divided.
Therefore, you taught sentient beings an undivided single vehicle.

Because sentient beings have the impurities that make them err,
They do not perceive the profound scope of the buddhas.
Tathagata, because you possess wisdom together with the means of compassion,
You vowed: "I shall liberate sentient beings."

Just as a wise [captain] will [miraculously] manifest a beautiful city,
To relieve his crew when voyaging to an island of jewels,
Likewise, you connected your [shravaka and pratyekabuddha] disciples with the [lower]
vehicles to give them peace,
[While] you spoke otherwise to those with trained minds, free [from emotions].

Sugatas in the buddhafi elds of all the directions,

Numerous as the particles and atoms in these –
For as many aeons will you enter holy supreme enlightenment.
Yet, this secret of yours should not be told.

Victor, as long as the worlds have not attained supreme peace,
As long as the sky has not disintegrated,
You, born from the Mother of Wisdom and nursed by her loving kindness,
How could you enter supreme peace?

As they ignorantly eat the poisonous food of ordinary experience,
Your care for your family of ordinary individuals,
[Is greater than] the sufferings of the mother of a poisoned child,
Thus you, protector, will not enter supreme peace.

Because they are ignorant, fixating on [things as] real or unreal,
Because they suffer from birth and death, from not achieving the wanted, and being
struck by the unwanted,
Because of the destination of the evil, you are moved by tenderness for the world,
Bhagawan, through compassion you have shunned peace and not chosen nirvana.

According to this tradition, the bhikshu Chandrakirti,
Here condensed the treatises of Madhyamika.
I have based this on the agramas,
And according to the [oral] instructions.

There are other teachings,
But they are unlike this.
Thus, there is nothing comparable to this tradition.
This has been confirmed by the wise.

Frightened by the hue of the great waters of Nagarjuna's mind,
Individuals remain removed from this good tradition.
By this arrangement of [Nagarjuna's] words, which are like dew that opens the water
lily,
The wishes of Chandrakirti have now been completely fulfilled.

Through previous habituation, individuals will realize the terrifying profundity of the
suchness explained,
Yet, others will not understand such realization even though they may have studied
greatly.
Therefore, seeing [the teachings of] other traditions as merely applying to themselves,

Give up the way of studying the treatises of all traditions, and be content with just this.

May the merit of relating the excellent tradition of Acharya Nagarjuna pervade the limits of space;

May this morning star light up that dark sky of the afflicted mind;

And, by acquiring this jewel from the cobra-head of the mind,

May the entire world through realizing suchness, reach the level of the Sugata.